

Getting MyAccentTrainer Live

A plain-English guide to putting your platform on the web

Right now, MyAccentTrainer runs on your computer. Everything works — but only you can see it, and only when your machine is running. "Going live" means giving it a real web address (like **myaccenttrainer.com**) that anyone, anywhere, can open in a browser at any time.

This guide walks you through it in plain language. You do **not** need to understand code. Where a step is genuinely technical, I've prepared the exact files for you and marked clearly where a developer's half hour would be money well spent.

Take it at your own pace. Nothing here can break the version on your computer.

The big picture

Going live has three parts. Two of them are just clicking through websites; one is a small technical switch I've already prepared for you.

Part A — Put your code online. Your app lives in a folder on your computer. To publish it, that folder needs a home on the internet first. The standard, free home for code is a service called **GitHub**.

Part B — Create the website and its database. A service called **Vercel** takes your code from GitHub and turns it into a live website automatically. In the same place, you'll create the online database that stores your users and their progress.

Part C — One technical switch. On your computer, the app uses a simple database (a single file). A live website needs a proper online database instead. This is the one real code change — and I've written the replacement files so no one has to figure them out from scratch.

That's the whole journey. The rest of this guide is each part, click by click.

Before you start

You'll want about **45 minutes**, and two free accounts you can make in a couple of minutes each:

- A **GitHub** account — where your code lives: github.com
- A **Vercel** account — what turns it into a live site: vercel.com (sign up with your GitHub account and the two connect automatically)

Both have free tiers that are genuinely enough to launch and share MyAccentTrainer with early users. You won't be asked for a card to get started.

One honest note before you dive in: **Part C is the one step where 30 minutes with any web developer will save you real time.** You can absolutely do it yourself by following along — but if you know someone technical, this is the moment to borrow them. Everything they need is prepared and included at the end of this guide.

Part A — Put your code on GitHub

Think of GitHub as a shared drive built for code. Your app needs to live there so Vercel can reach it.

1. Go to github.com and create a free account (or sign in).
2. Click the **+** in the top-right corner and choose **New repository**.
3. Name it `myaccenttrainer` and set it to **Private** (only you can see it). Click **Create repository**.
4. GitHub then shows a page with commands for uploading your code. This is the one spot that touches the code folder — the easiest way through it is **GitHub Desktop**, a free app that uploads your folder with a few clicks instead of typed commands:
 - Download it from desktop.github.com.
 - Open it, sign in, and choose **Add** → **Add Existing Repository**, then pick your `myaccenttrainer-v2` folder.
 - Click **Publish repository**. Your code is now safely on GitHub.

If you have a developer helping, this is a two-minute task for them and you can skip the details above.

Part B — Deploy on Vercel and create your database

This is the satisfying part — where a real web address appears.

1. Go to vercel.com and click **Sign Up**. Choose **Continue with GitHub** so the two link automatically.
 2. On your Vercel dashboard, click **Add New... → Project**.
 3. You'll see your GitHub repositories. Find `myaccenttrainer` and click **Import**.
 4. Vercel detects it's a Next.js app on its own — you don't need to change the build settings. **Don't click Deploy yet**; first create the database (next step) so it's ready to connect.
 5. Open the **Storage** tab of your new project and click **Create Database**.
 6. Choose **Prisma Postgres**, pick the region closest to your first users, keep the free plan, give it a name, and create it. Then click **Connect** to attach it to your project.
 - Connecting the database automatically fills in the most important setting (`DATABASE_URL`) for you — you never have to copy or paste it.
 7. Add your other secrets under **Settings → Environment Variables** (the next section explains each one in plain English).
 8. Click **Deploy**. Vercel builds your site and, after a minute or two, gives you a live address like `myaccenttrainer.vercel.app`. That link works from any device, anywhere.
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Your secrets, in plain English

"Environment variables" is just a fancy name for a few private settings your live site needs. You add them in Vercel under **Settings → Environment Variables**. Here's what each one means and whether you need it now.

`DATABASE_URL` — the address of your online database. **You don't touch this** — Vercel fills it in when you connect the Prisma Postgres database in Part B.

`JWT_SECRET` — a long random password the app uses behind the scenes to keep logins secure. This one is **required** before going live. Generate one at generate-secret.vercel.app/40, then paste the result in. Treat it like a password: never share it.

`NEXT_PUBLIC_APP_URL` — your live web address. After your first deploy, set this to your real link (e.g. `https://myaccenttrainer.vercel.app`).

Azure Speech keys (*optional*) — these turn on professional pronunciation scoring. The app works without them, using its built-in practice estimate, so you can add these later when you're ready.

Stripe keys (*optional*) — these turn on paid memberships. Add them only when you want to start charging. Until then, leave them blank.

Part C — The one technical switch (prepared for you)

On your computer, MyAccentTrainer uses a tiny built-in database that lives in a single file. That's perfect for building, but a live website can't use it — online, the app needs a proper Postgres database (the one you created in Part B).

Making that switch is a small, well-defined change to four things. **You do not have to figure any of it out** — I've written the exact replacement files. They're in the `deploy/` folder alongside this guide, and the appendix below lists precisely what each one does.

Here's the honest framing: applying these four changes is straightforward for anyone comfortable with code, and takes about 20 minutes. If that's not you, hand the `deploy/` folder and the appendix to any web developer — it's a self-contained, clearly labelled task, and everything they need is spelled out. This is the single best place in the whole project to spend a little developer time.

After you're live

Your address. You start with a free `something.vercel.app` link — perfect for sharing with early users and investors. When you're ready, you can connect your own domain (like `myaccenttrainer.com`) in Vercel under **Settings → Domains**; Vercel walks you through it.

Updates happen by themselves. Once set up, every time your code is updated on GitHub, Vercel rebuilds and republishes the live site automatically — usually within a minute. There's no "re-upload" ritual.

You can watch it work. Vercel's dashboard shows every visit and every deploy, so you can see the site is healthy at a glance.

What it costs

You can launch and share MyAccentTrainer for **free**. Here's the honest shape of it as you grow.

Service	Free tier covers	When you'd start paying
GitHub	Private code storage	Essentially never, for this
Vercel	A live site with real traffic for early users	~\$20/month once you have steady, heavier usage
Prisma Postgres	A real database for your first users	A small monthly fee as your user count grows

In short: getting live and putting it in front of people costs nothing. Costs arrive only once you have real, growing usage — which is a good problem to have.

The realistic recommendation

You have two honest paths, and both are fine.

Do it yourself. Follow Parts A and B — they're just clicking through two friendly websites — and take your time with Part C using the prepared files. Give yourself an unhurried afternoon and you can absolutely get there.

Borrow a developer for one hour. Send them this guide and the `deploy/` folder. Parts A, B, and C together are roughly an hour of straightforward work for anyone technical, and you'll have a live, shareable link at the end of a single call.

Either way, the hard part — building a real, polished, working platform — is already done. This last mile is well-trodden ground, and everything you need to walk it is in your hands.

Appendix — the exact changes (for you or your developer)

These four prepared files live in the `deploy/` folder next to this guide. Each is small and clearly commented.

1. `schema.datasource.change.md` — a single-line edit in `prisma/schema.prisma`, switching the database type from `sqlite` to `postgresql`. Every part of your data design stays exactly the same.
2. `lib-prisma.production.ts` — the online version of the file that connects the app to its database. Going live means replacing the contents of `lib/prisma.ts` with this. It swaps the local file-database driver for the cloud Postgres driver.
3. `package.json.changes.md` — two small additions so the database client rebuilds automatically on the server, plus the one-time commands that swap the local database driver for the cloud one.
4. `.env.production.example` — a plain-English list of the secrets from the section above, showing exactly what goes into Vercel's settings.

After applying these and connecting the database in Vercel, the app creates its tables on the online database automatically on the first deploy. From that point on, your live site and your database are working together — and MyAccentTrainer is on the web.